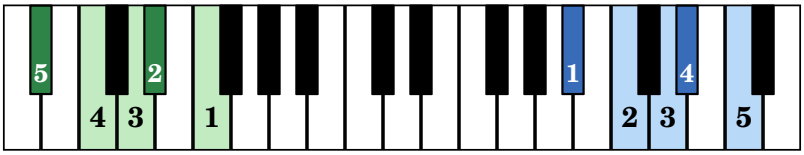
Unit 5

B-flat Major

New: Two flats (B-flat and E-flat); B-flat major and its chords

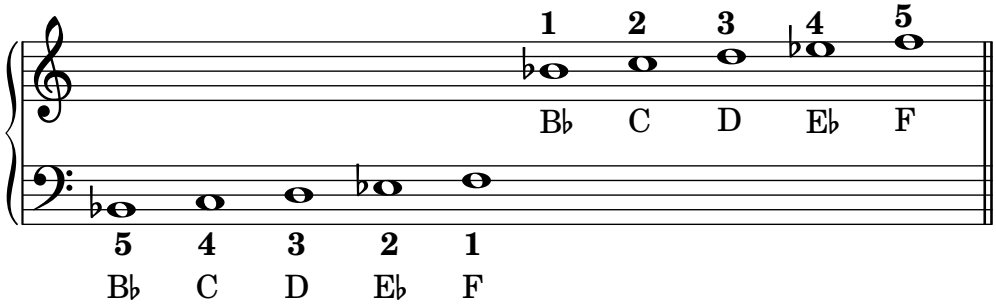
B-flat major has two flats: B-flat and E-flat. Its home note is a black key, so both hands start with the thumb or finger 5 on B-flat. It feels strange for a day or two, and then very comfortable, because the hand sits a little further into the keys.



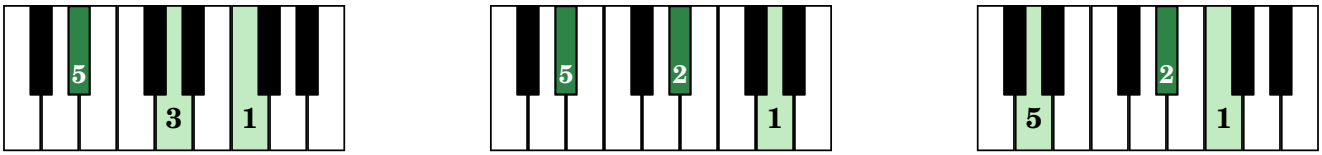
Middle C

Left hand B-flat position and Right hand B-flat position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

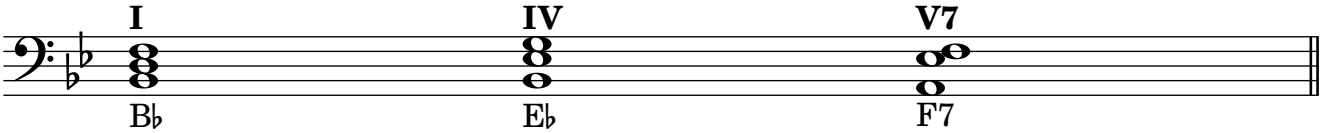


B-flat major: left-hand chord shapes



I = B♭ **IV** = E♭ **V7** = F7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Two flats

The key signature has a flat on the B line and in the E space. The scale is B-flat C D E-flat F G A B-flat.

B-flat position

Right hand: B-flat (1) C (2) D (3) E-flat (4) F (5). Left hand: B-flat (5) C (4) D (3) E-flat (2) F (1). Two of the five keys are black.

Chord shapes in B-flat

I is B-flat D F (5 3 1), IV is B-flat E-flat G (5 2 1) and V7 is A E-flat F (5 2 1).

Reading tips

1. Put the thumb (right hand) or finger 5 (left hand) on B-flat before you start, and check where E-flat is.

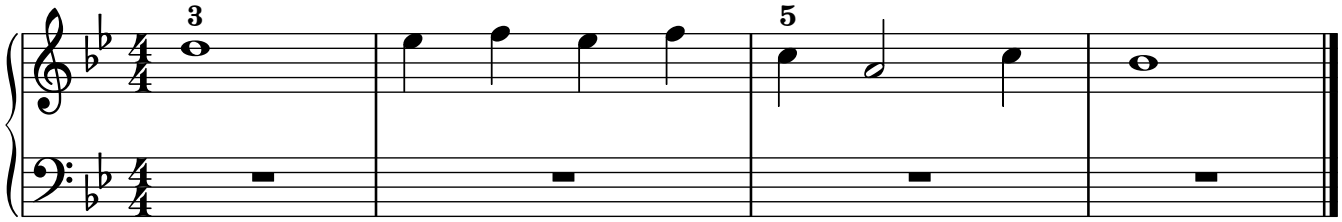
2. F position (F G A B-flat C) also fits B-flat major: the right hand often moves between the two.

3. Say 'B-flat, E-flat' aloud while you scan the key signature.

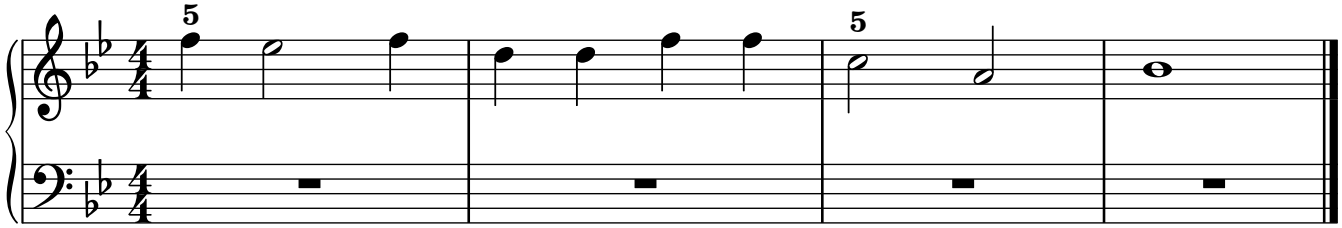
Part A: Right hand in B-flat major ♩ = 60

Right hand in B-flat major, moving between B-flat position and F position.
Metronome 60.

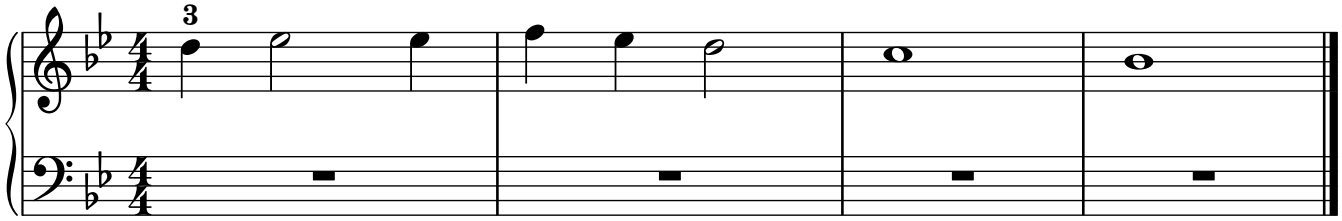
☐ **5.1**



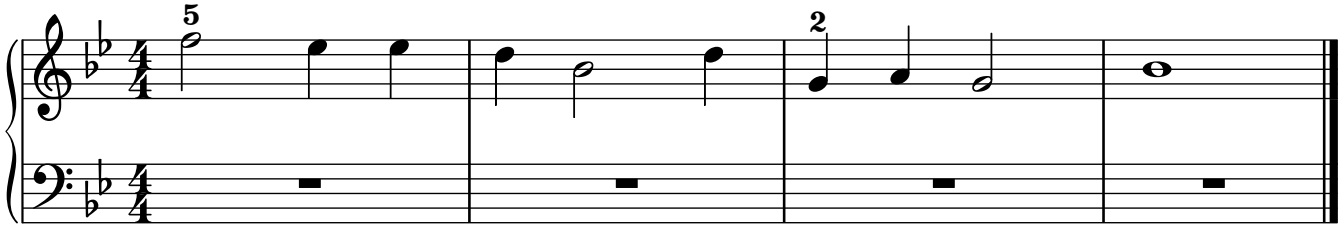
☐ **5.2**



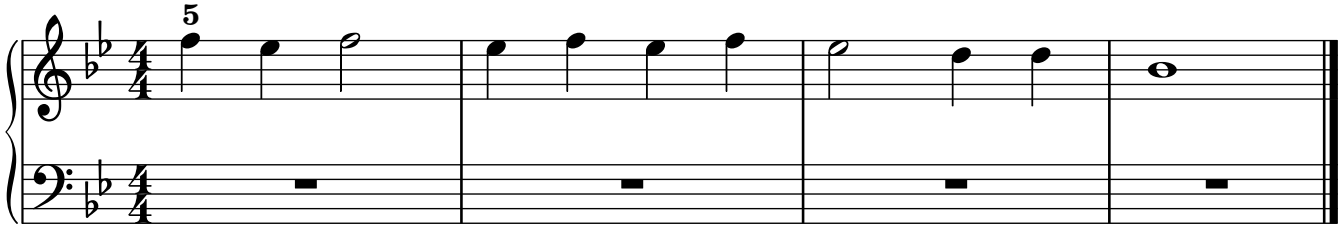
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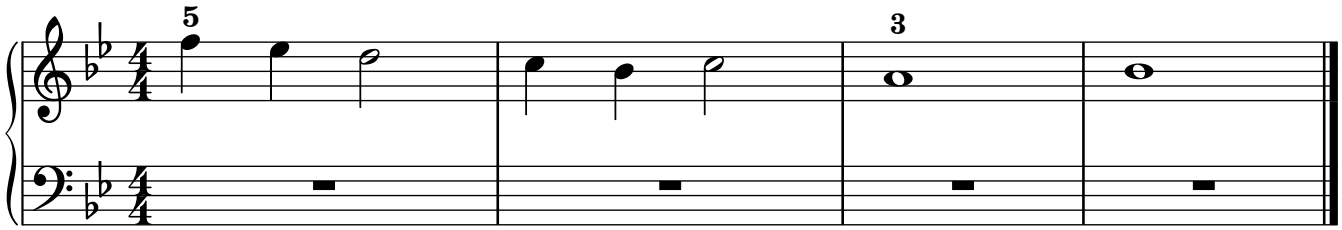
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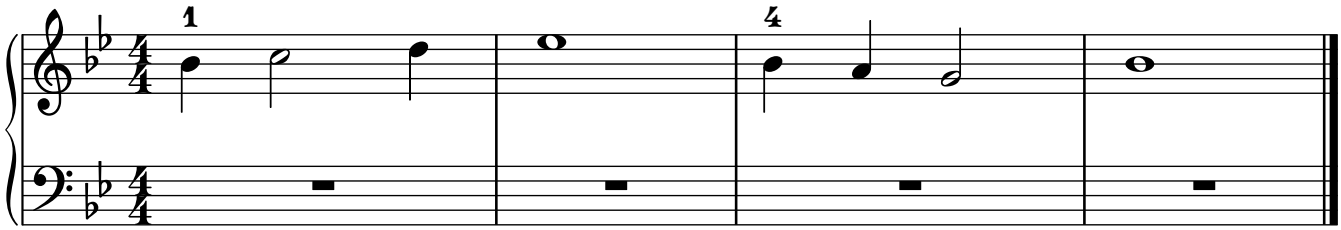
☐ **5.5**



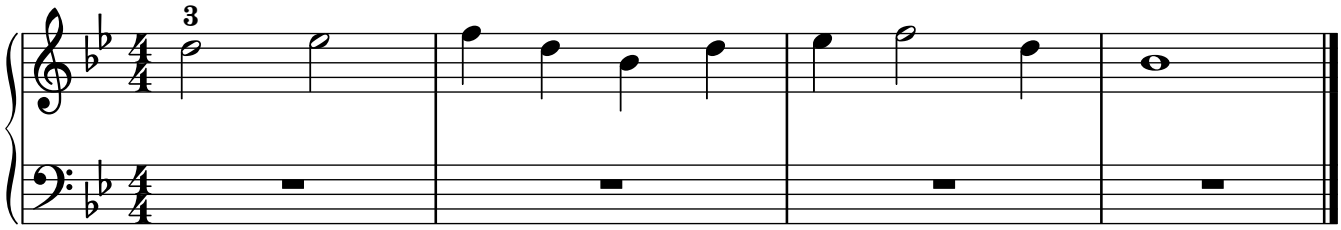
☐ **5.6**



5.7



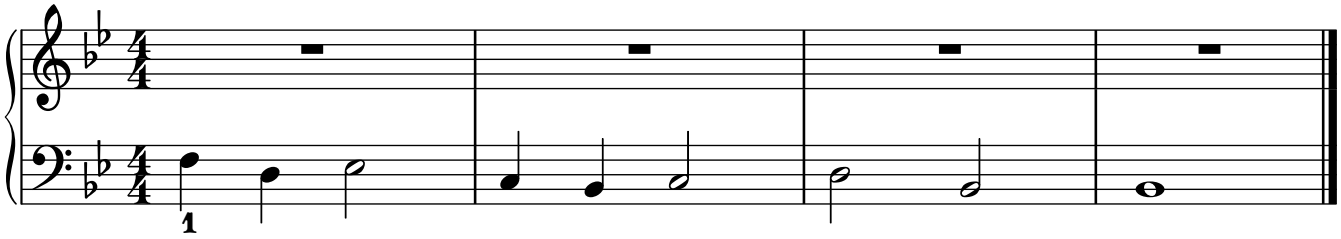
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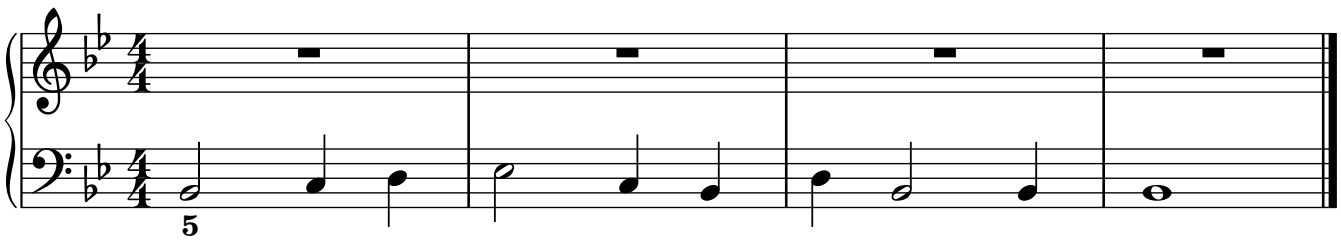
Part B: Left hand in B-flat major ♩ = 60

Left hand in B-flat position. B-flat is the second line; E-flat is the third space.

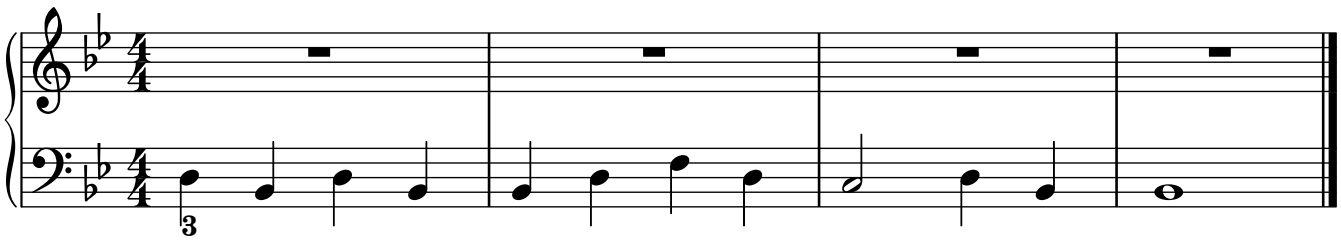
☐ **5.9**



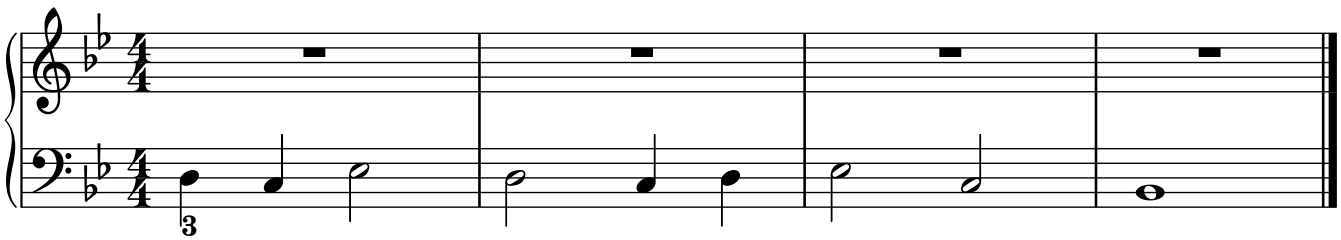
☐ **5.10**



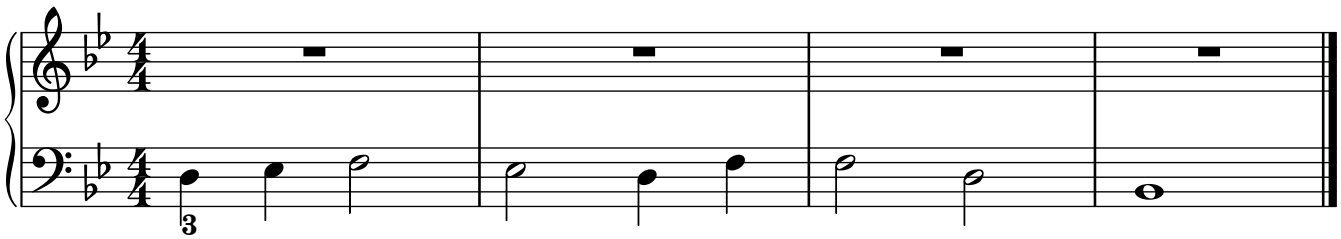
☐ **5.11**



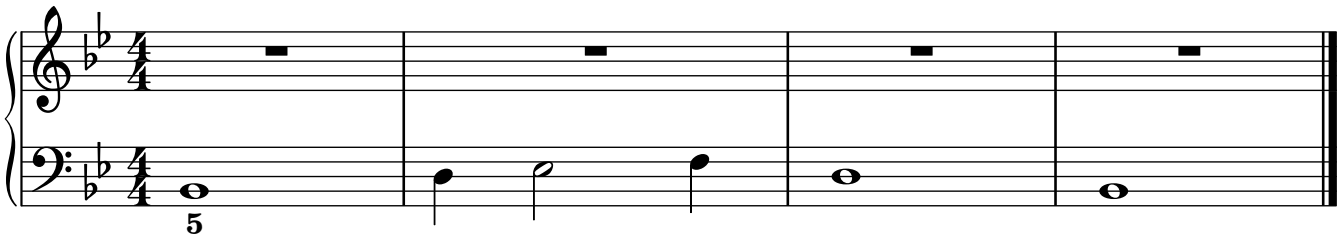
☐ **5.12**



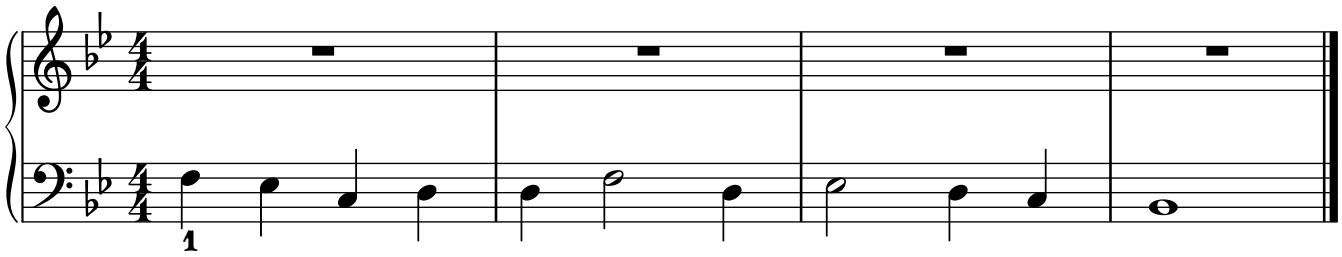
☐ **5.13**



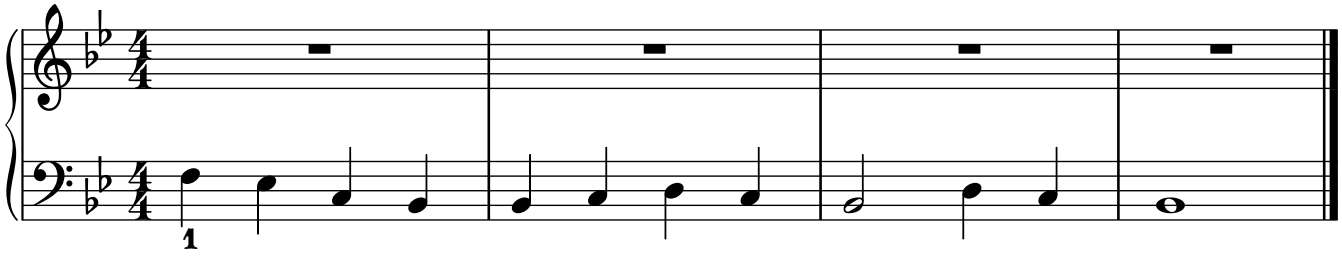
☐ **5.14**



5.15
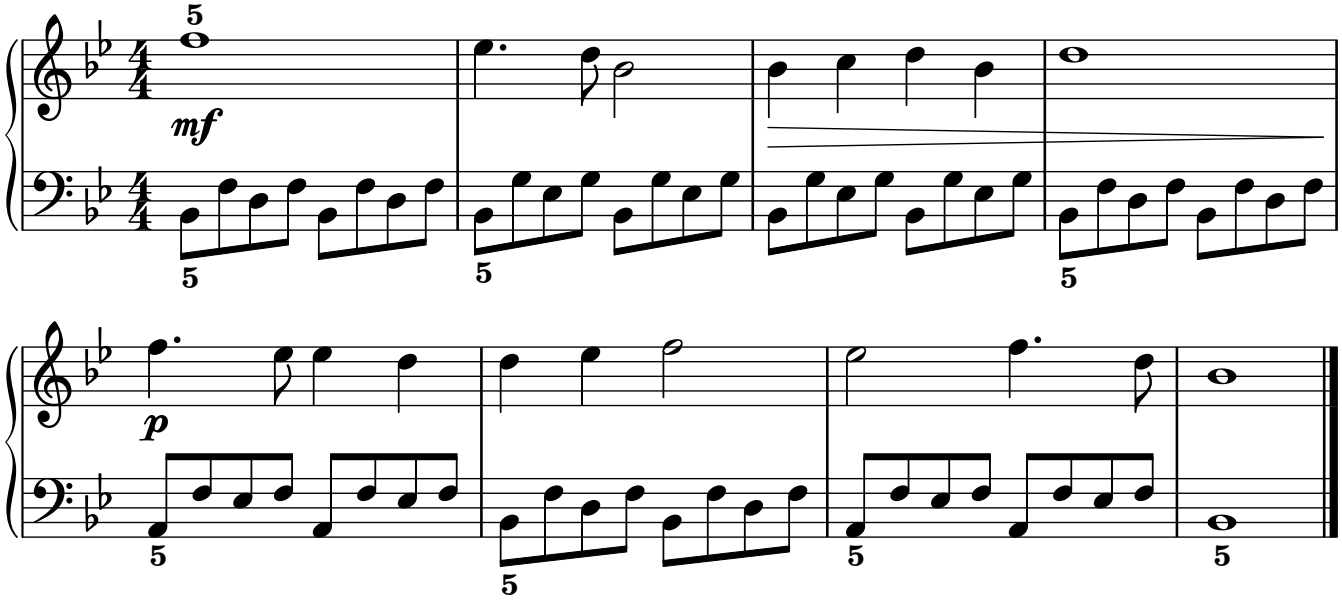


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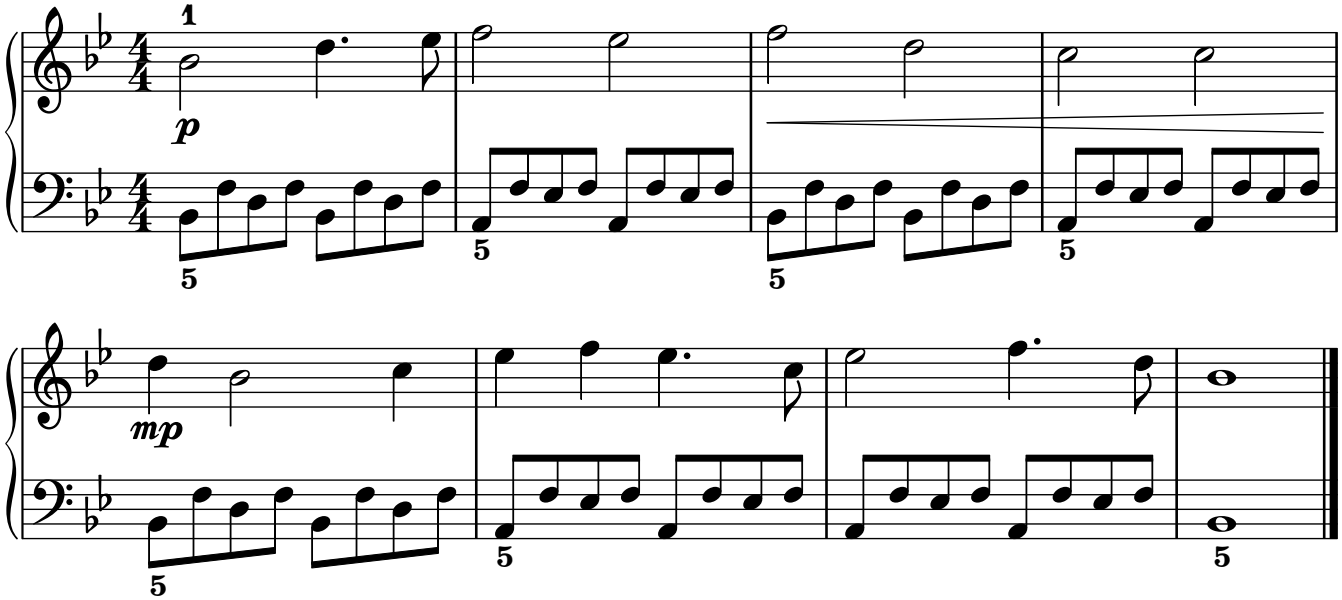


Part C: Alberti bass in B-flat major ♩ = 60

An Alberti bass in B-flat major.

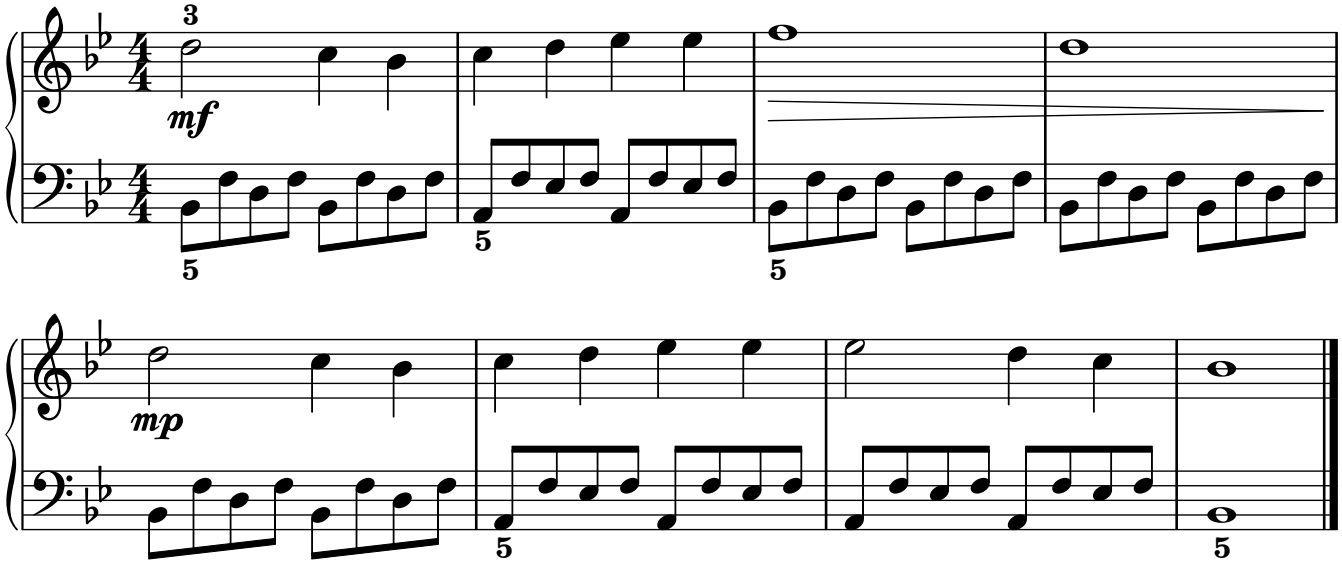
☐ **5.17**



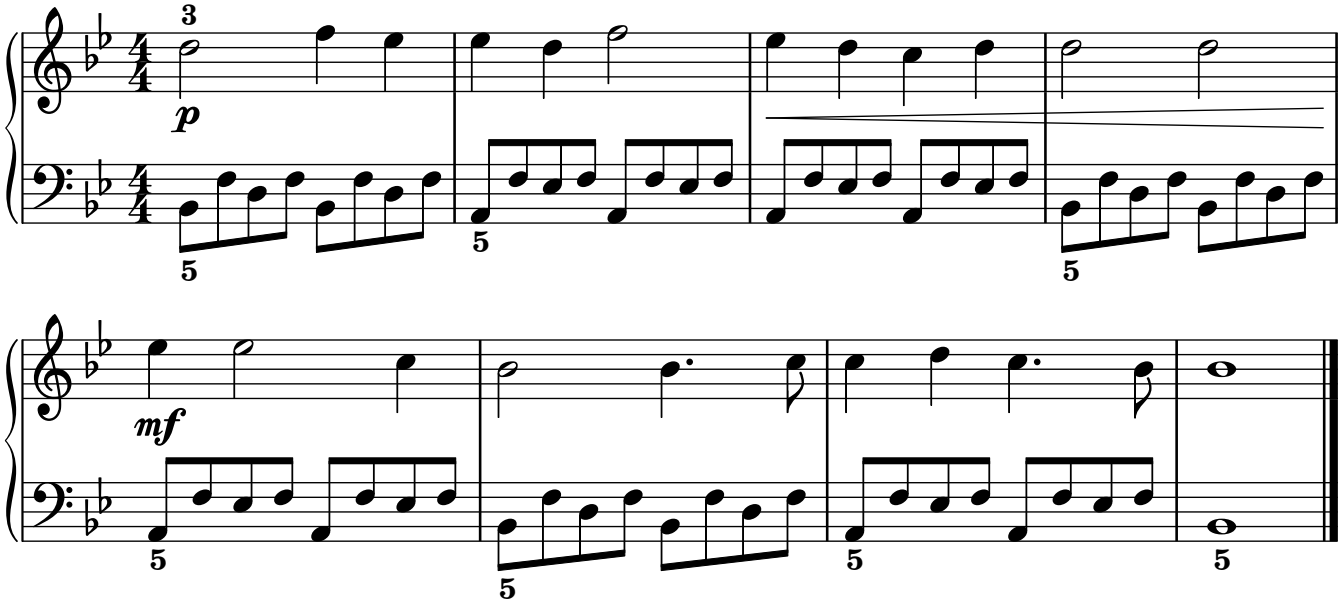
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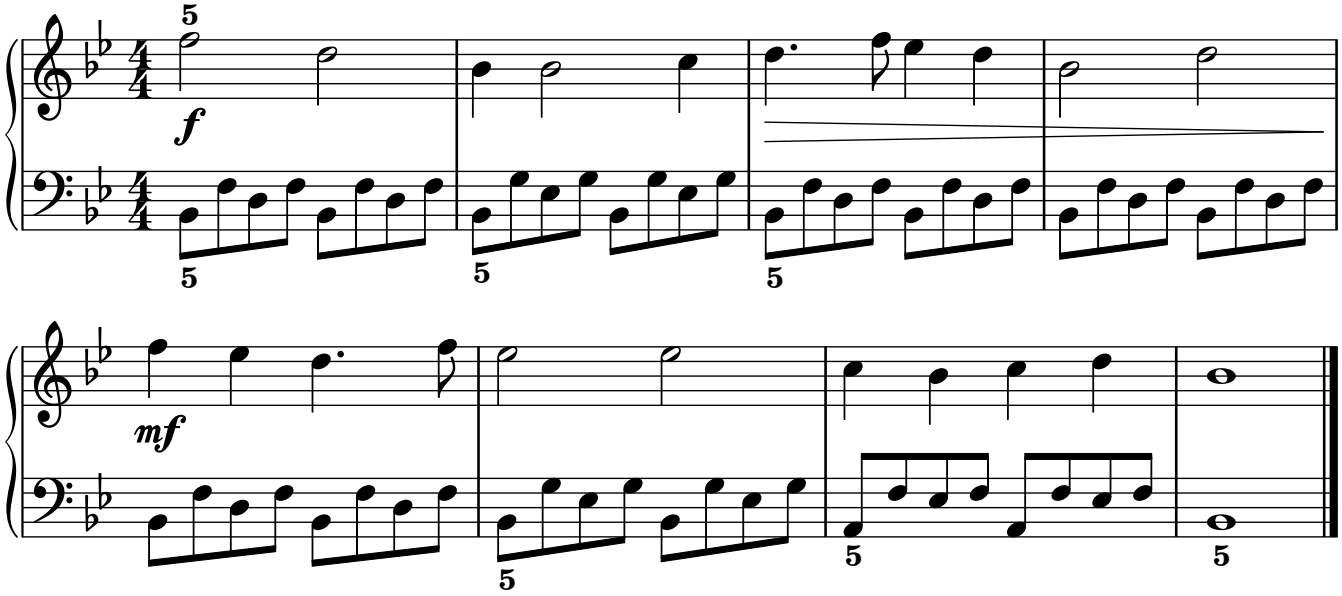


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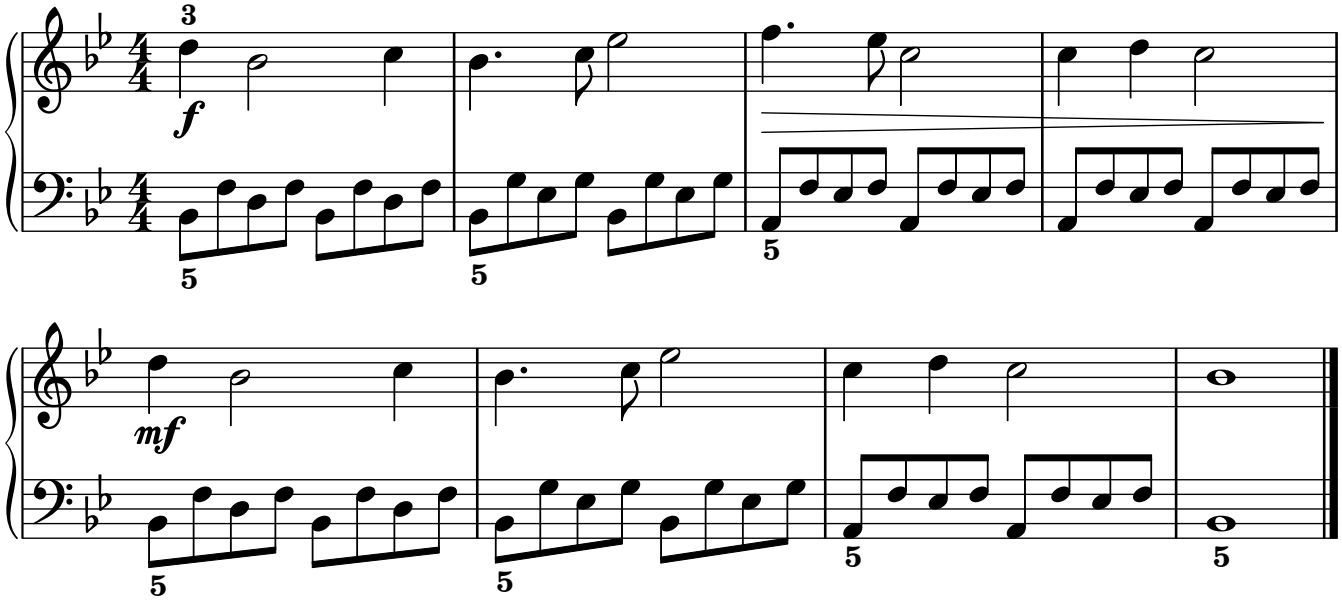


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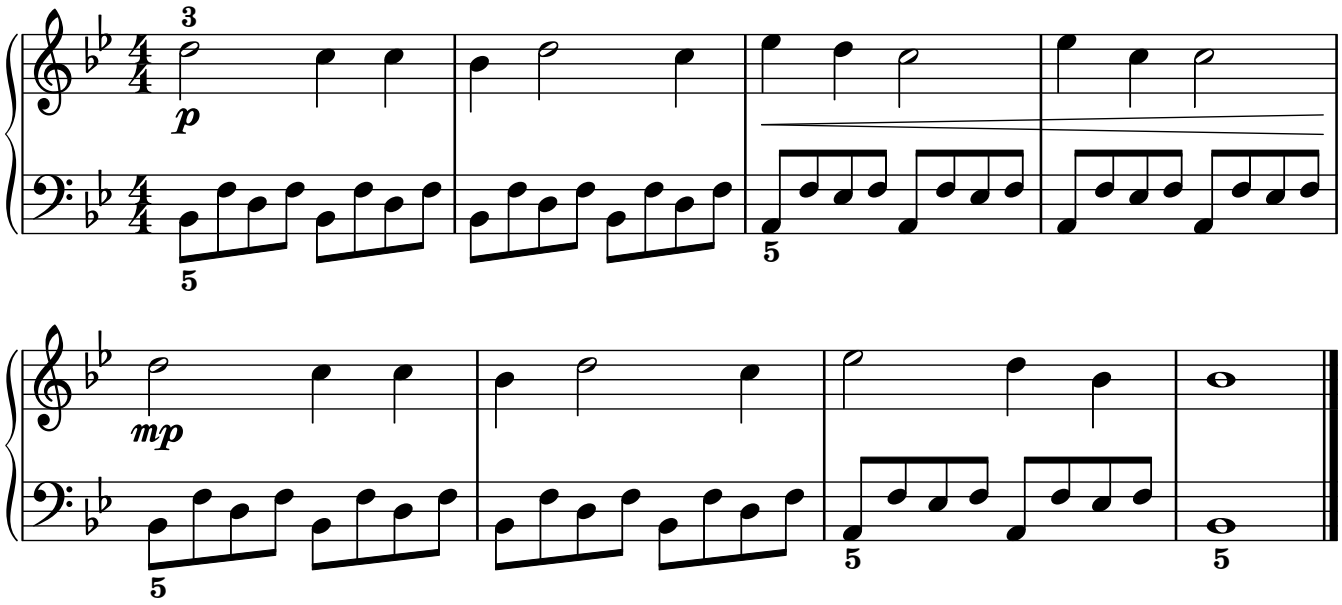
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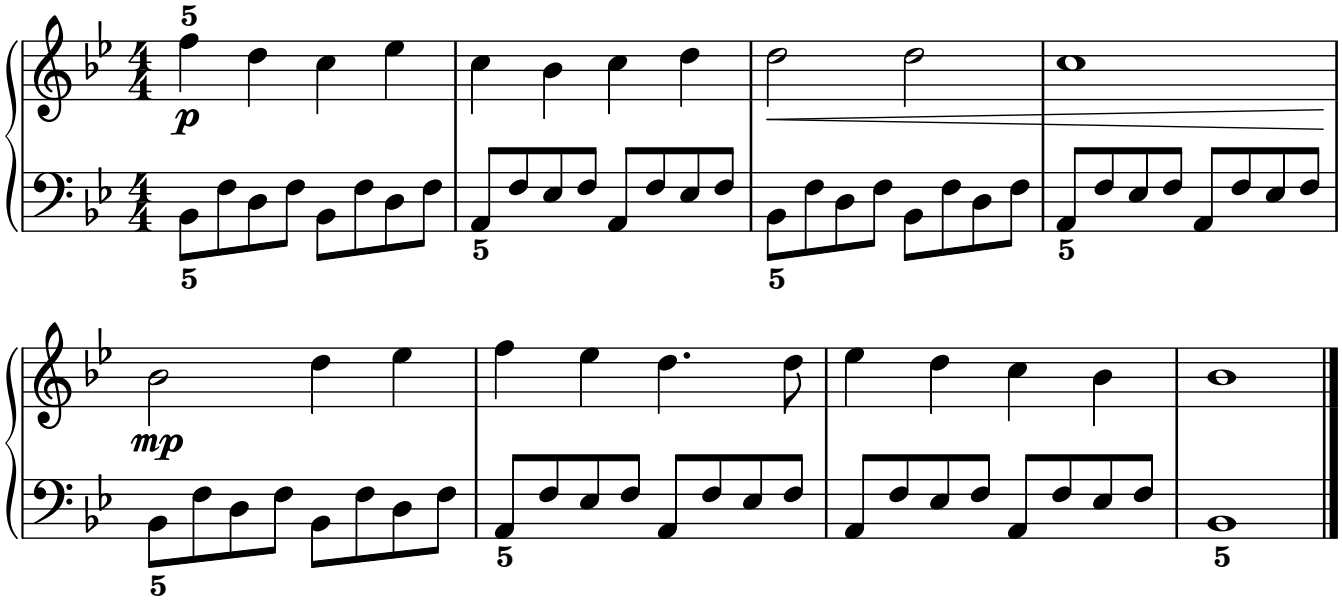
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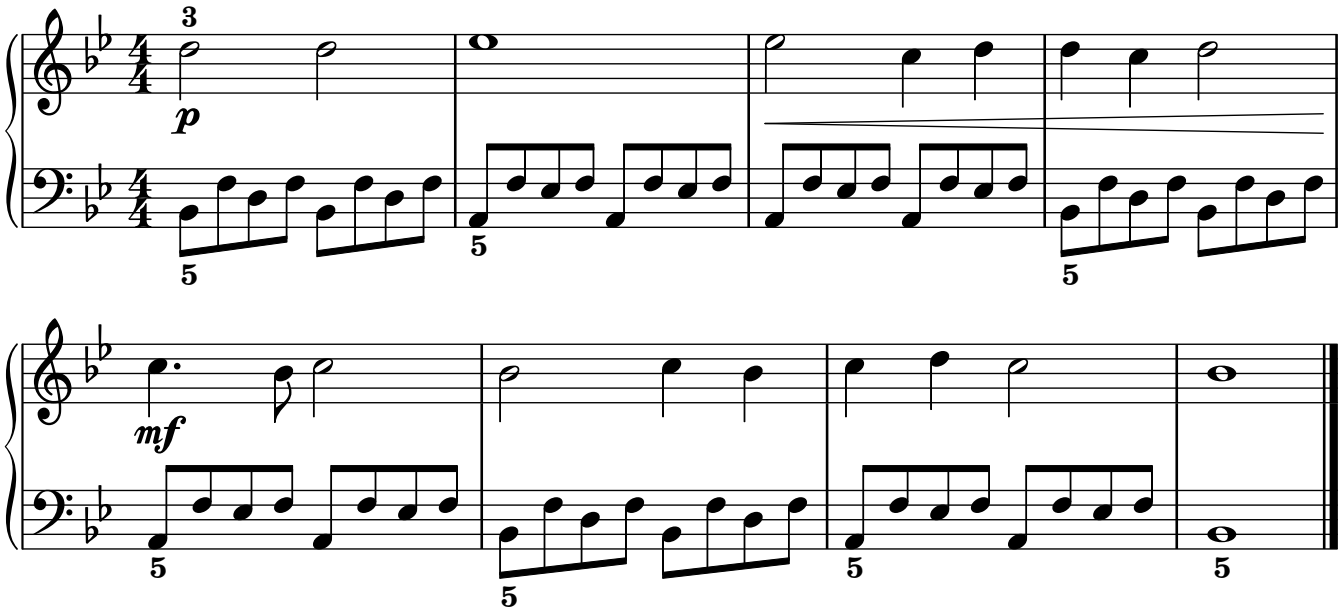
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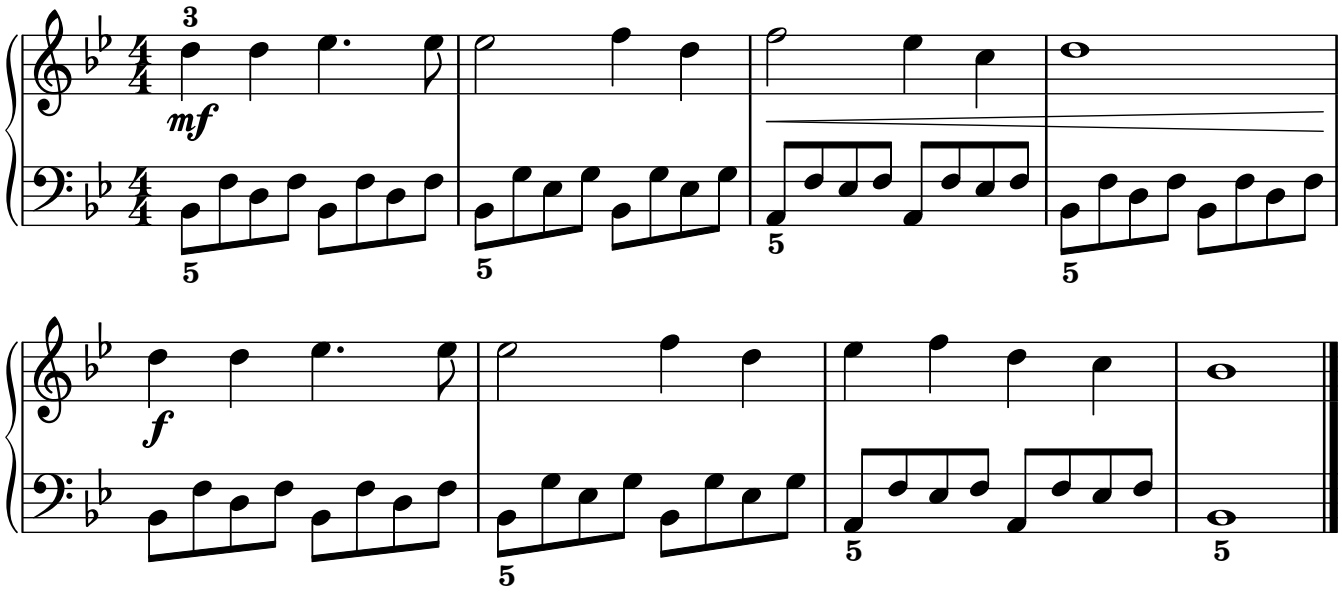


5.24



5.25



5.26

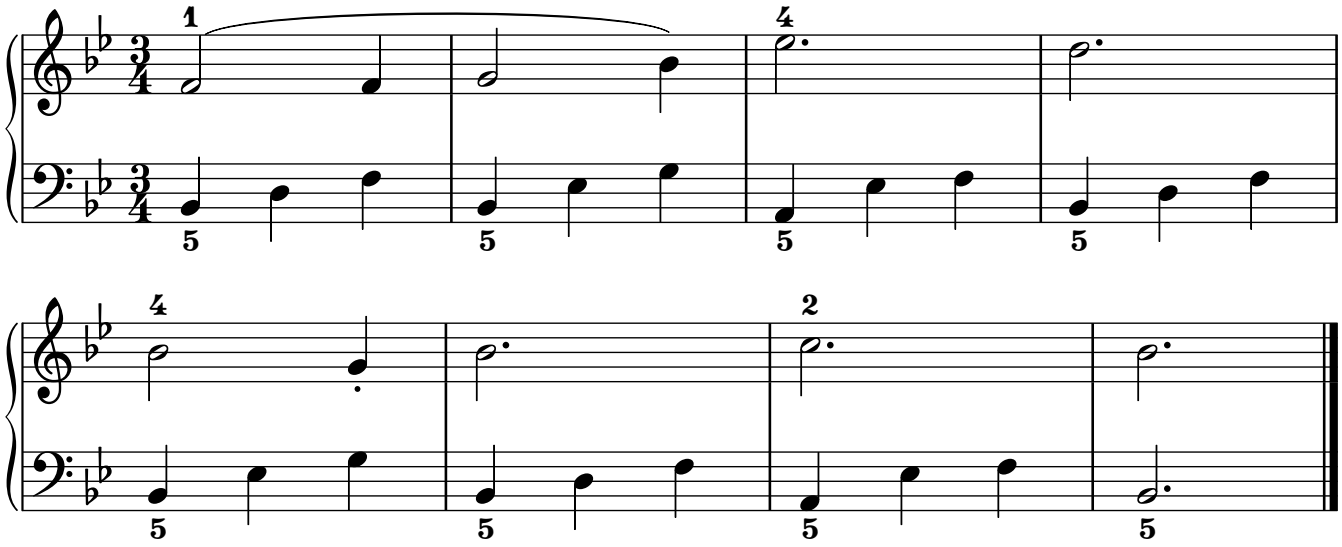


Part D: A B-flat waltz on the move

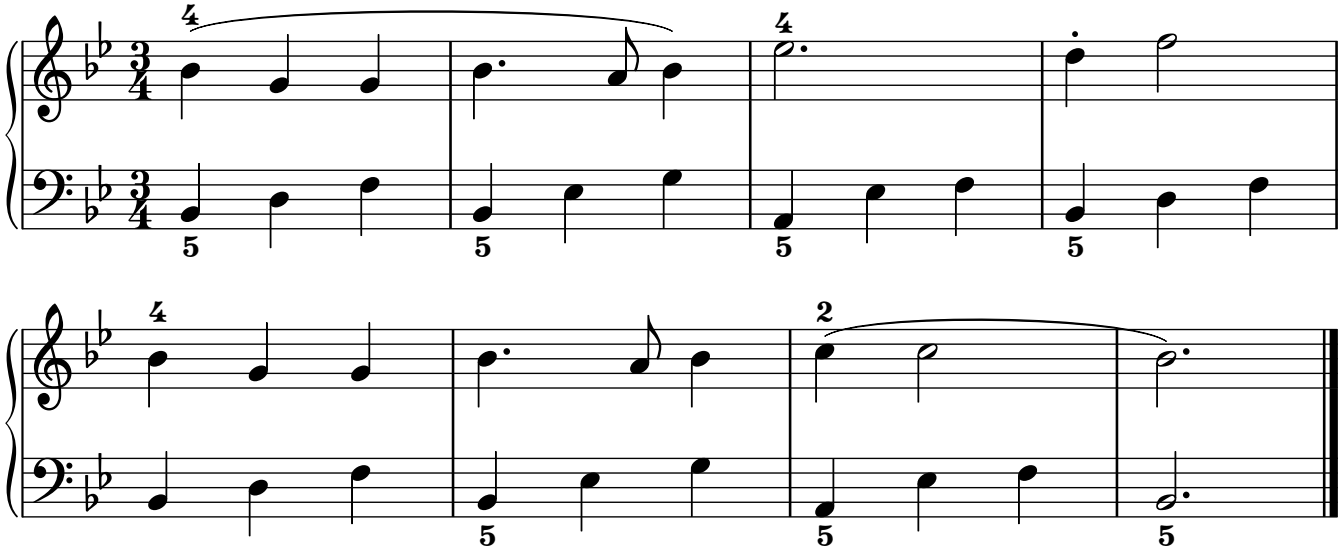
♩ = 72

A waltz. The right hand moves between F position and B-flat position.

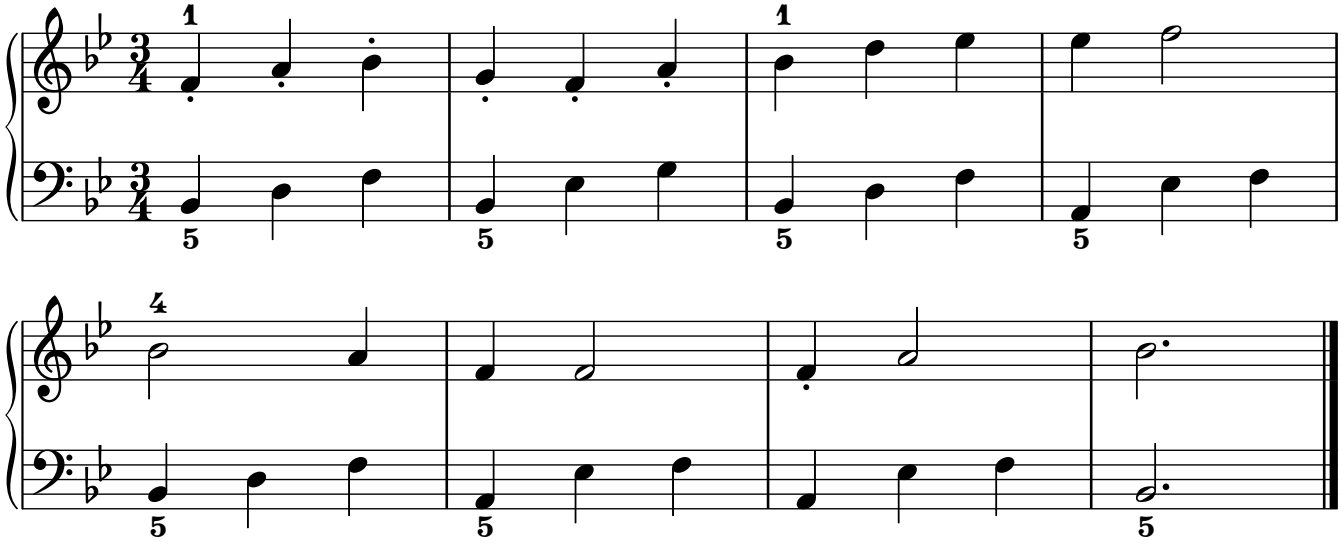
☐ **5.27**



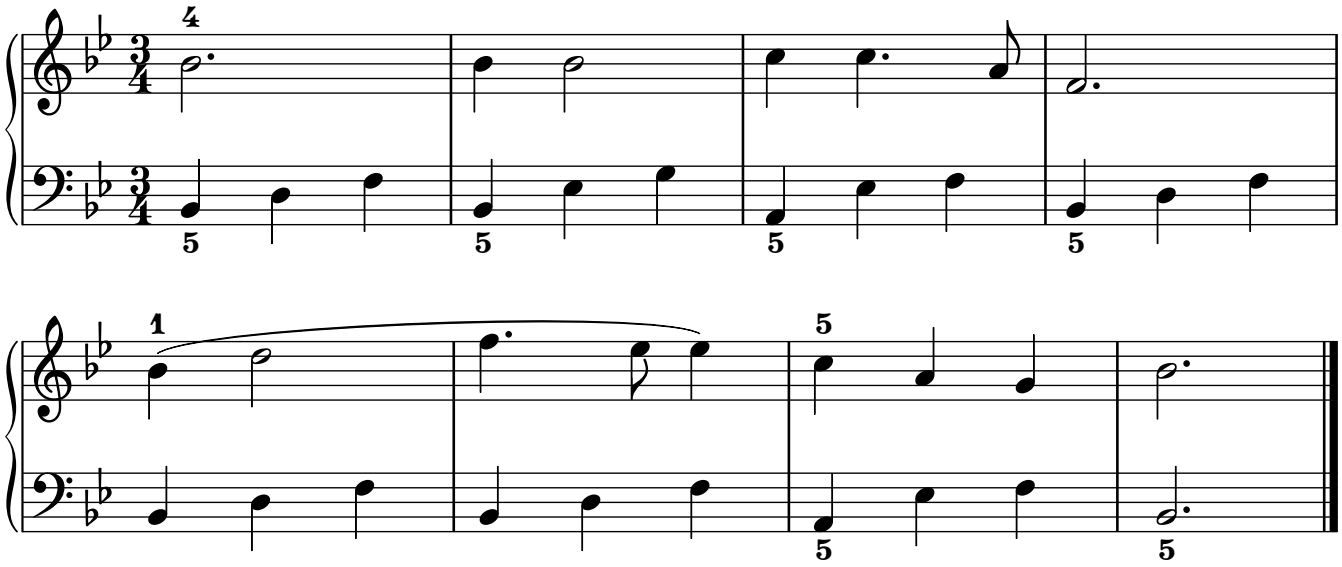
☐ **5.28**



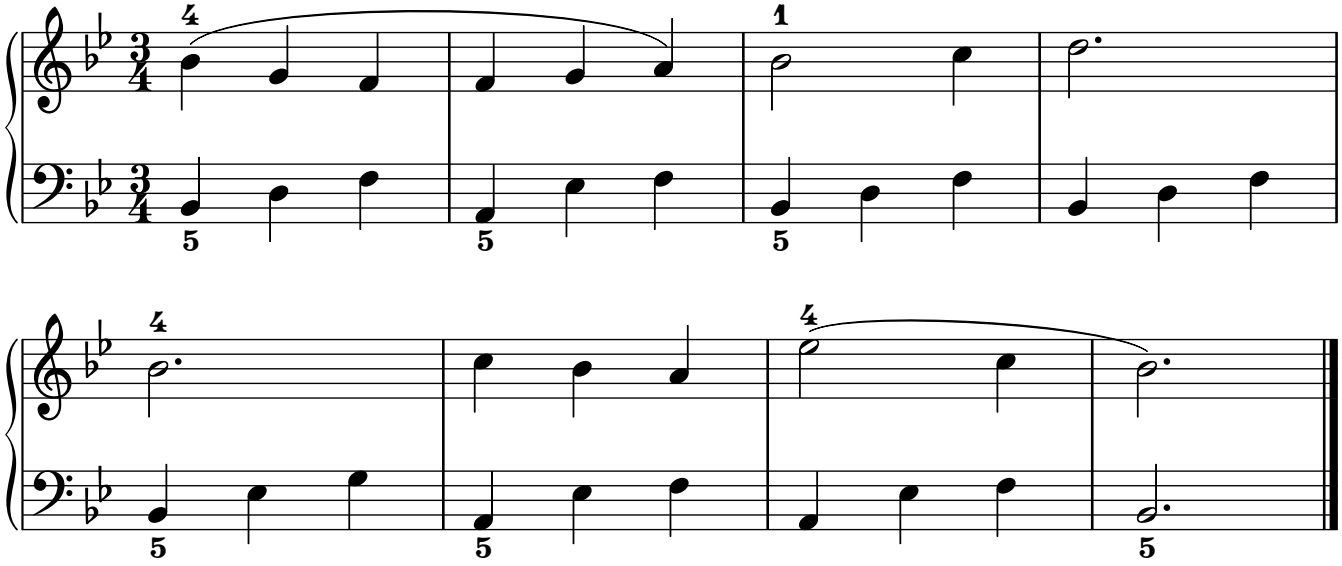
☐ **5.29**
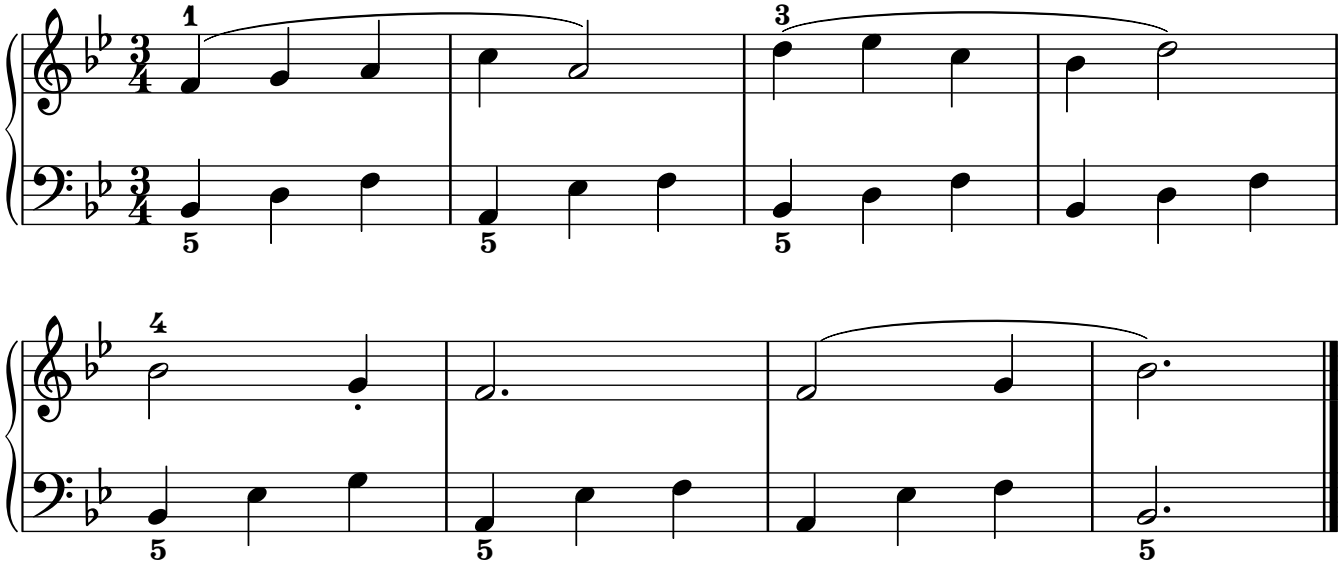


5.30



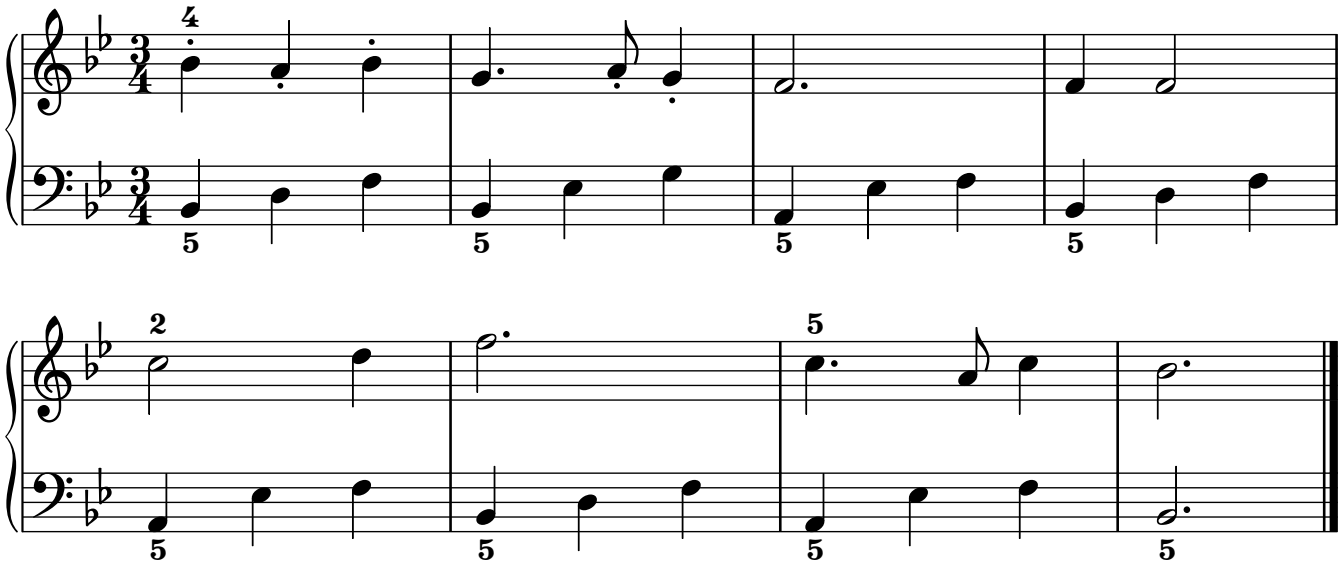
5.31



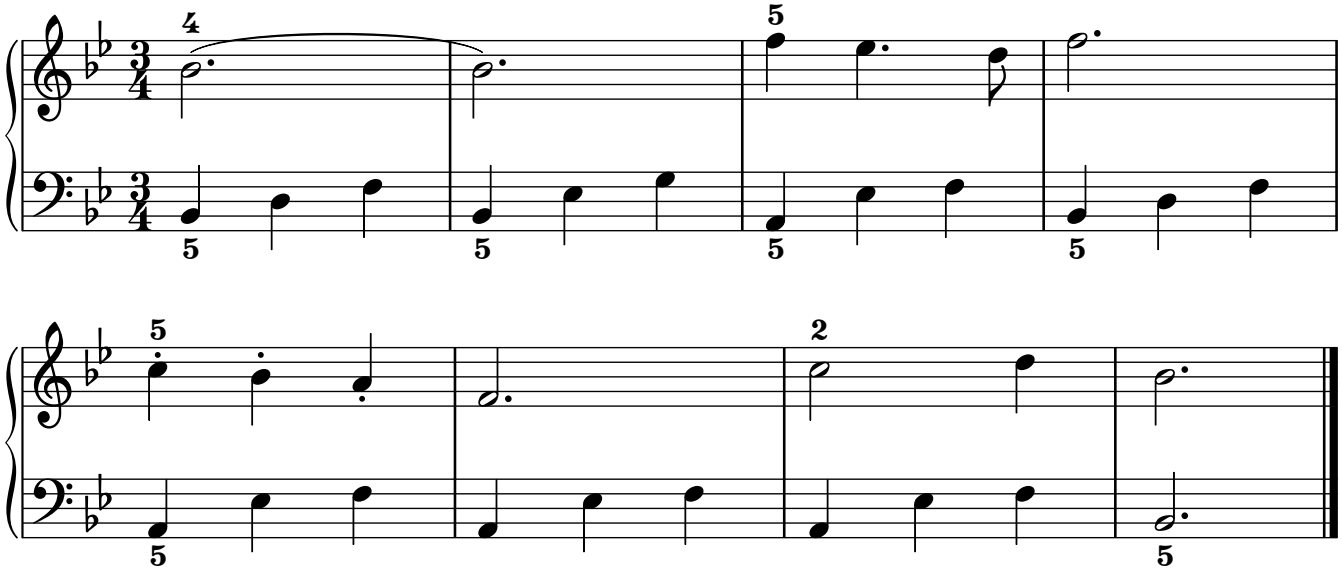
5.32



5.33



5.34
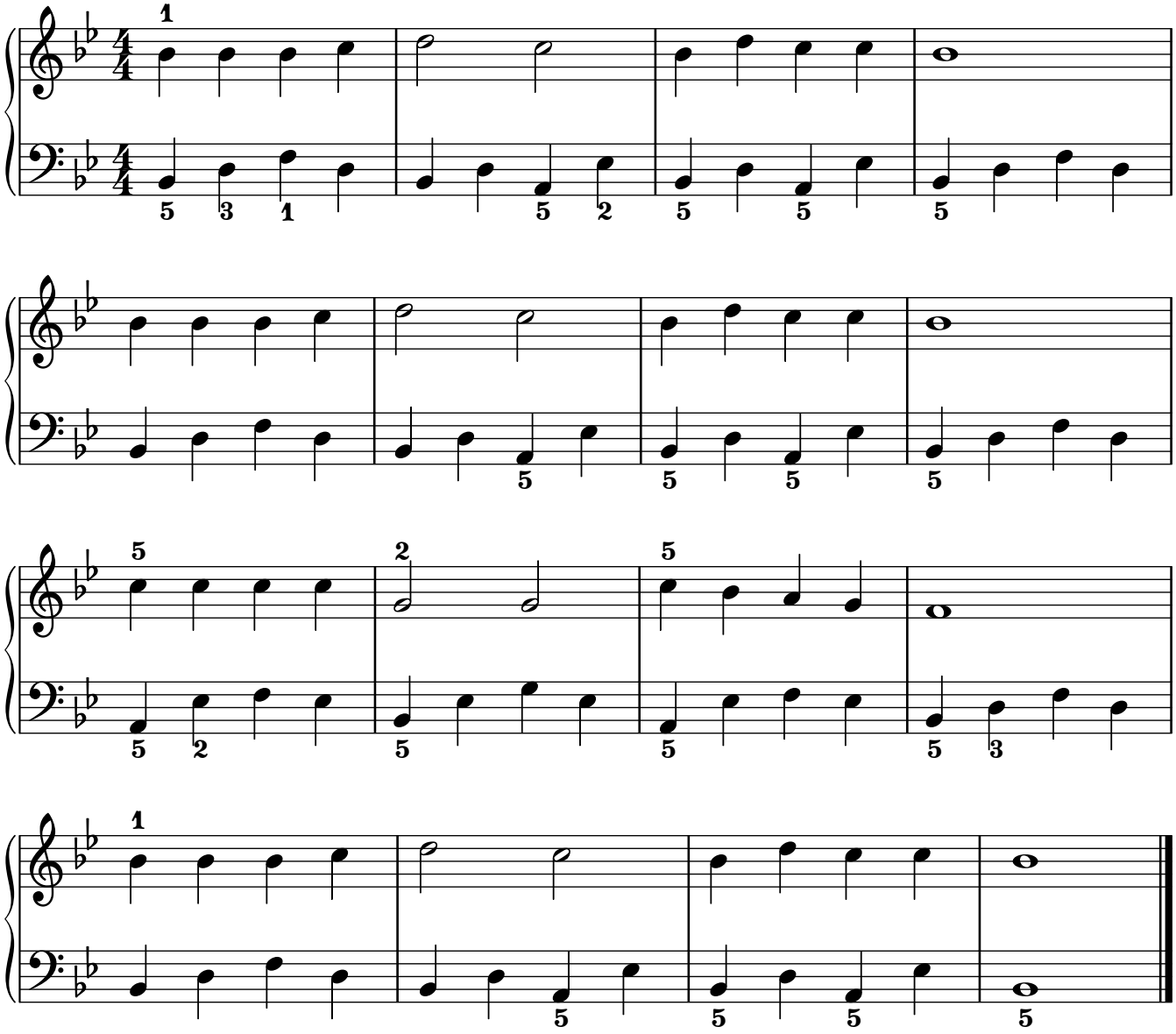


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Au clair de la lune ♩ = 84

Traditional French song

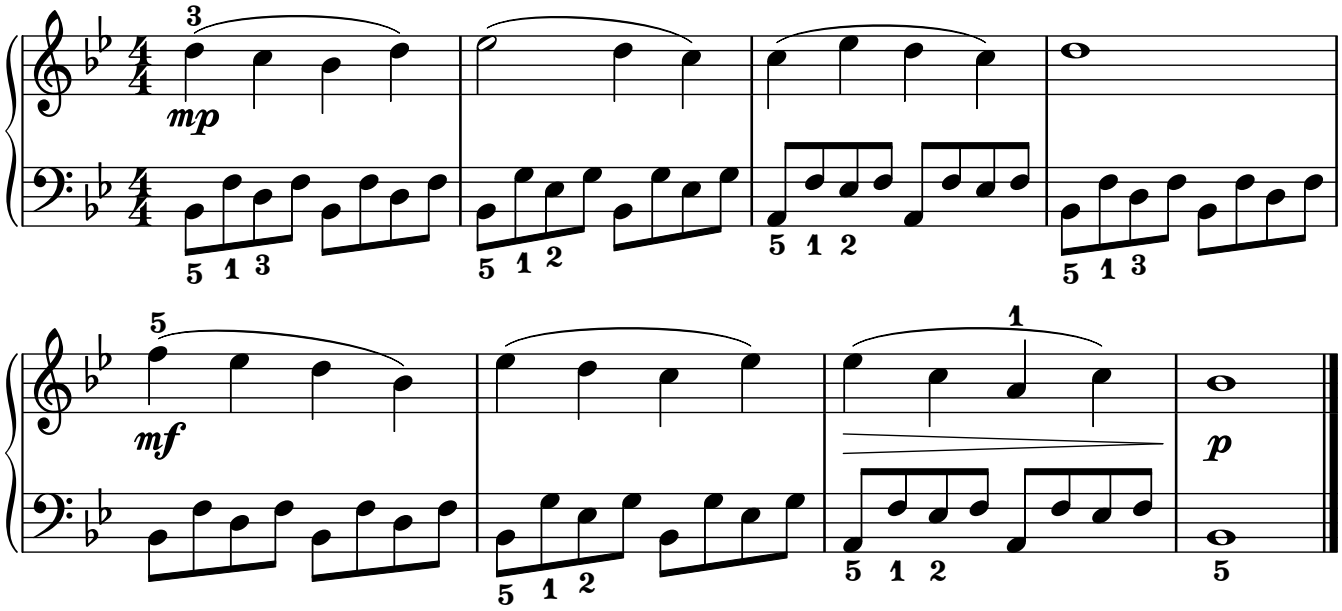
The song from Volume 1, now in B-flat major. In bar 9 the right hand moves down to F position (finger 5 on C) and in bar 13 back to B-flat position. The left hand plays broken chords.



Song in B-flat ♩ = 72

Original
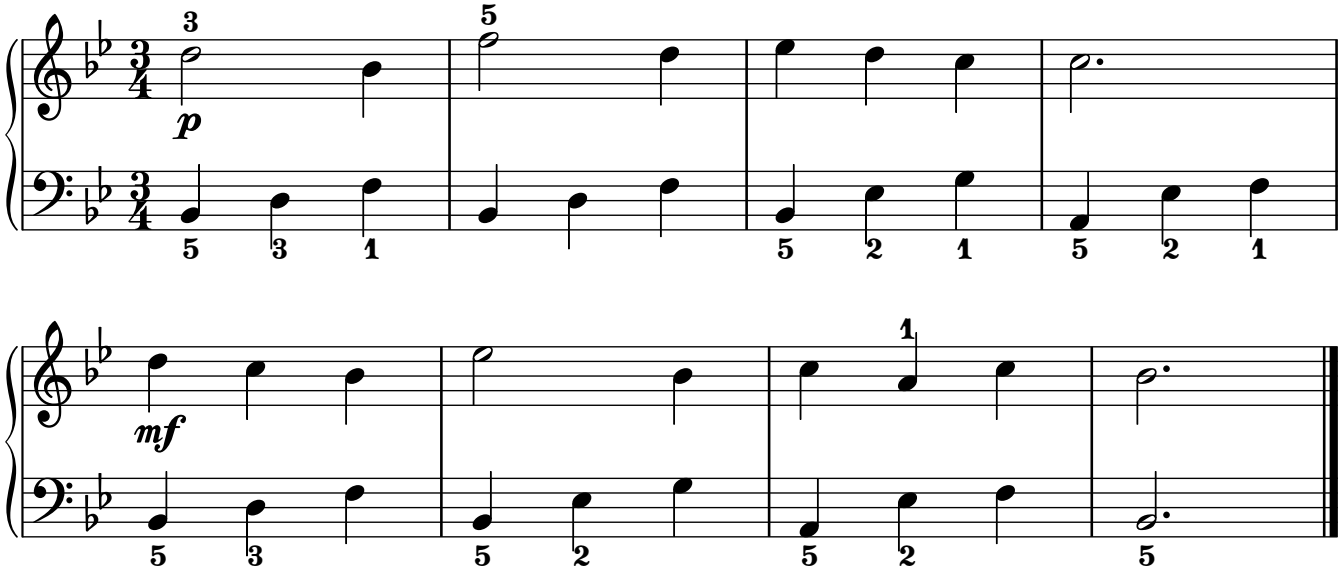
A singing tune over an Alberti bass. In bar 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to A, the note below B-flat, and resolves up to B-flat.



Waltz in B-flat ♩ = 84

Original

Watch the left hand in bars 4 and 7: from the top of IV (G) it reaches down to A for V7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play five new Part C or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every B and E is flat, in both hands.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.